

# $H \rightarrow WW + \text{charm}$

## Analysis status

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**2022postEE · 26.7 fb<sup>-1</sup> · expected UL 1034**

# Sections

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| § | topic                                           |
|---|-------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Analysis and selection                          |
| 2 | MVA-defined regions                             |
| 3 | c-tagging — 2D working points and scale factors |
| 4 | Negative-weight reweighting                     |
| 5 | W+jets jet-binned samples                       |
| 6 | Systematics and impacts                         |
| 7 | Status and outlook                              |

Dedicated decks: [ctag-sf-deck.pdf](#) (34 slides) · [negrw-deck.pdf](#) (57 slides)

# 1 · Analysis and selection

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# Why H+c

The Higgs coupling to **charm** is the least constrained of the accessible Yukawas. Associated production **H + c** probes it directly, without relying on the  $H \rightarrow c\bar{c}$  decay.

|                   |                                                                      |
|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>production</b> | $pp \rightarrow H + c (+X)$                                          |
| decay             | $H \rightarrow WW^* \rightarrow 2\ell 2\nu$                          |
| final state       | <b>opposite-sign <math>e\mu</math></b> + MET + $\geq 1$ c-tagged jet |
| dataset           | 2022postEE, <b>26.7 fb<sup>-1</sup></b> , ReReco 22Sep2023           |

The  $e\mu$  requirement removes  $Z \rightarrow ee/\mu\mu$  by construction, so the irreducible background is **real  $t\bar{t}$**  rather than Drell-Yan.

Reference: **AN-23-102**, the full Run 2 analysis at 138 fb<sup>-1</sup>.

# Signal and final state

**H → WW → 2ℓ2ν, produced with a charm quark.**

Final state: **opposite-sign eμ + MET + ≥1 c-tagged jet**

| object    | selection                                                                 |
|-----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| muons     | tight ID + tight PF iso, $p_T > 10$ , $ \eta  < 2.4$                      |
| electrons | wp80iso, $p_T > 10$ , $ \eta  < 2.5$ , $\Delta R(e,\mu) > 0.4$            |
| ll pair   | OS, $p_T > 20 / 10$ , pair $p_T > 30$ , $m_{ll} > 12$                     |
| jets      | $p_T > 30$ , $ \eta  < 2.4$ , tight-lep veto ID, $\Delta R(j,\ell) > 0.4$ |
| c-jets    | $p_T > 20$ , <b>PNet medium</b> CvL/CvB                                   |
| MET       | PuppiMET                                                                  |

eμ removes the  $Z \rightarrow ee/\mu\mu$  peak **by construction** — the irreducible background is **real t $\bar{t}$** , not Drell-Yan. Triggers: MuonEG, SingleMu, SingleEle.

# Signal region composition

| process           | SR yield      | share of SR   |
|-------------------|---------------|---------------|
| $t\bar{t}$        | 17,744        | 82.3%         |
| st                | 1,543         | 7.2%          |
| vjets             | 1,523         | 7.1%          |
| diboson           | 609           | 2.8%          |
| higgsbkg          | 132           | 0.6%          |
| <b>H+c signal</b> | <b>0.26</b>   | <b>0.001%</b> |
| <b>total</b>      | <b>21,552</b> |               |

The signal is **0.26 events** against ~21,600 background — which is why MC statistics, rather than data statistics, drives the sensitivity.

## 2 · MVA-defined regions

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## Six classes, one network

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| setting  | value                                                        |
|----------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| model    | SimpleMLP_MultiClass (b-hive)                                |
| classes  | hplusc, higgsbkg, tt, st, diboson, vjets                     |
| features | <b>26</b> , including the <b>11 c-tag one-hot categories</b> |
| training | 30 epochs, batch 1024, lr 1e-3, loss weighting on            |
| split    | 80/20, deterministic by NanoAOD event id                     |

The 11 one-hot categories mean the network sees the **full 2D CvL/CvB plane** — the same information the scale factors are binned in, not a binary pass/fail.



# argmax defines the regions

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The winning class picks the channel; the winning score is the discriminant.

| region      | events | dominant process   |
|-------------|--------|--------------------|
| SR_hplusc   | 21,552 | <b>tt 82.3%</b>    |
| CR_higgsbkg | 9,220  | tt 86.4%           |
| CR_tt       | 44,199 | <b>tt 94.1%</b>    |
| CR_st       | 20,135 | tt 87.6%           |
| CR_diboson  | 6,585  | tt 72.4%           |
| CR_vjets    | 9,214  | <b>vjets 43.2%</b> |

Regions are **orthogonal by construction** — no cut optimisation to tune or defend, and every event is used somewhere.

## Four of five CRs are tt-dominated — by design

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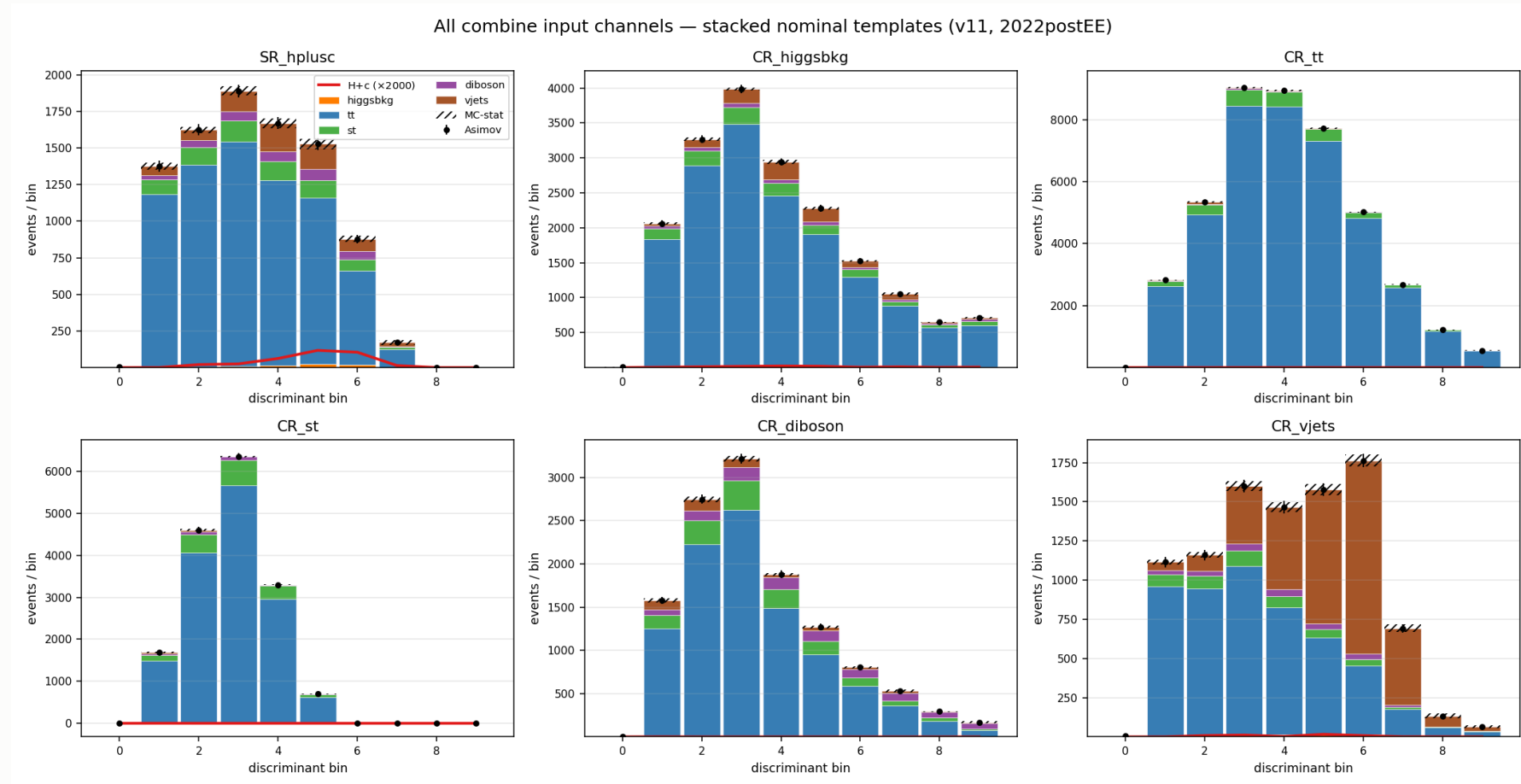
The SR is itself **82% tt**: in an ep final state  $t\bar{t}$  is dominant everywhere, so a tt-rich CR is expected, not a failure.

**CR\_tt: 94.1% purity over 44k events.** It pins the free-floating `rate_tt`, which covers 82% of the SR — the single most valuable constraint in the fit.

**CR\_vjets holds 59.6% of all V+jets** in the fit. Without it there is no V+jets constraint from anywhere.

Collapsing the CRs to single bins was **measured**: +33 units for three CRs, ~+50 for all five. The shapes carry real constraint, so all six channels keep 10 bins.

# Templates entering the fit



6 channels  $\times$  6 processes  $\times$  10 bins. **CR\_vjets** (bottom right) is the only region where V+jets (orange) is visible — it carries 59.6% of all V+jets in the fit.

## 3 · c-tagging

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# From working points to a plane

PNet gives **two** discriminants per jet: **CvL** (charm vs light) and **CvB** (charm vs bottom). A single working-point cut throws most of that away.

The calibration instead partitions the **whole plane** into **11 categories** L0, C0–C4, B0–B4 — including the untagged L0 bin.

| property   | value                                                            |
|------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| axes       | CvL, CvB — <b>verified sufficient</b> , no third variable needed |
| categories | 11: L0, C0 – C4, B0 – B4                                         |
| index      | computed from CvL/CvB <b>already stored per jet</b>              |
| applied    | natively in the processor ( CTag2DCorrector )                    |

Because the scheme spans the **full plane including L0**, the SF machinery works even for a selection with no working point at all.

# Only 7 of 11 categories are populated

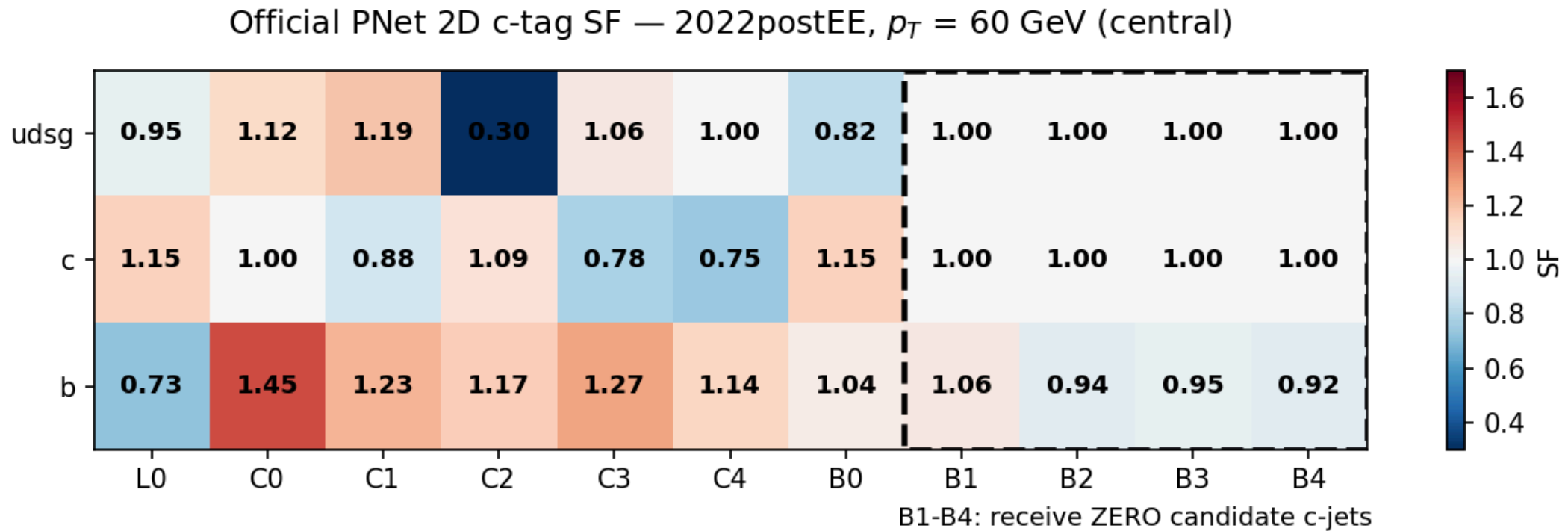
Occupancy of the five largest ( C4 and B0 are populated but sparse):

| category | jets    | c (%) | b (%)       | light (%)   |
|----------|---------|-------|-------------|-------------|
| L0       | 130,694 | 13.5  | 4.7         | <b>81.8</b> |
| C0       | 188,702 | 28.2  | 6.2         | 65.7        |
| C1       | 170,043 | 58.0  | 7.9         | 34.1        |
| C2       | 17,823  | 58.6  | 33.4        | 8.0         |
| C3       | 1,082   | 30.6  | <b>57.9</b> | 11.5        |

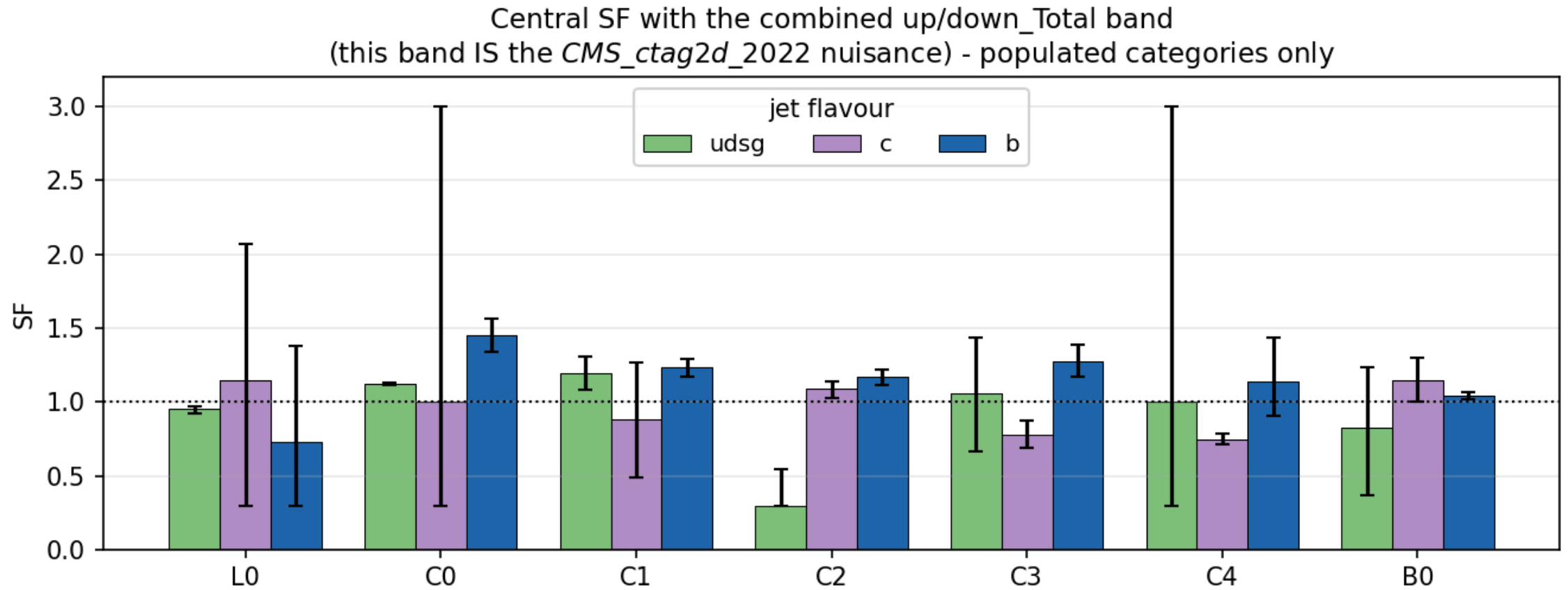
The scheme targets a broader phase space than ours — the b-rich B1 – B4 categories are empty after the  $e\mu$  + c-jet selection.

Category index is computed from CvL/CvB already stored per jet — **no NanoAOD reprocessing was ever needed.**

# The scale factor matrix



# The uncertainty band is the nuisance





## What the calibration costs

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| configuration     | limit       |
|-------------------|-------------|
| no SF             | 1150        |
| + CMS_ctag2d_2022 | <b>1164</b> |

Applying the calibration **worsens** the limit by 14 units — as it must.  
A scale factor adds a nuisance. The point is correctness.

Currently **one nuisance** covering the whole plane. Decorrelation is pending.

## 4 · Negative-weight reweighting

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full detail: `negrw-deck.pdf` (57 slides)

# The estimator is a cancellation

aMC@NLO events carry **signed** weights. The yield estimator

$$\hat{N}_B = \sum_{i \in B} w_i, \quad w_i = \pm |w_i|$$

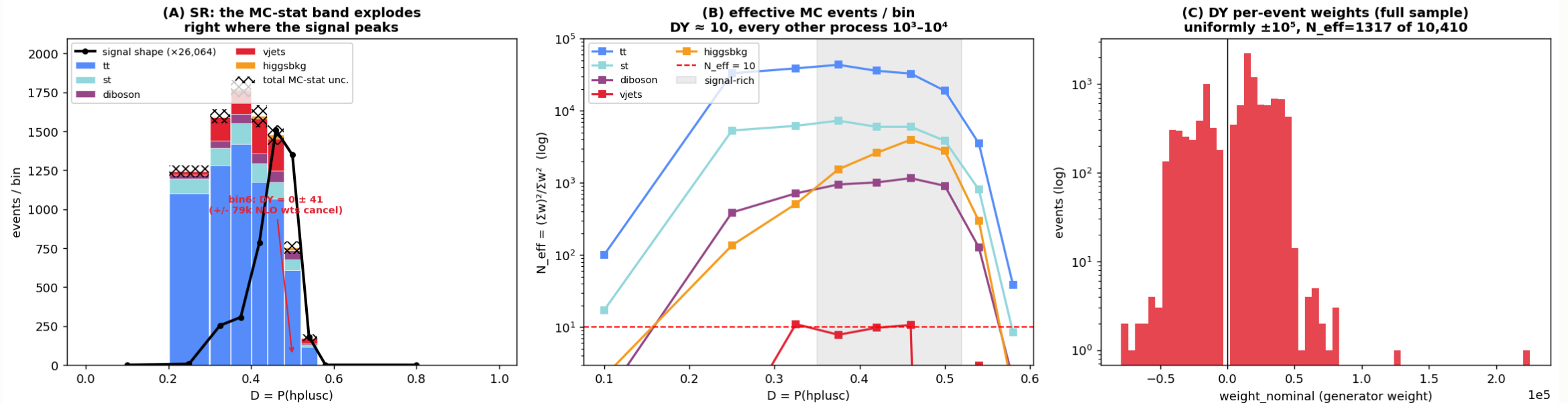
is a **difference of two large numbers**.

- the **expectation** is correct — the yield is unbiased
- the **variance** is not: it scales with  $\sum w_i^2 = \sum |w_i|^2$ , the *unsigned* statistics, while the mean is the much smaller signed sum
- effective statistics collapse:  $N_{eff} = (\sum w)^2 / \sum w^2 \ll N$

**16.4%** of our V+jets events carried a negative weight. In a sparse bin the positives and negatives can cancel **completely** — leaving zero content with a large finite error.

# V+jets was starved exactly under the signal

autoMCStats blow-up = DY (vjets) is starved in the H+c signal region



(A) the MC-stat band explodes where the signal peaks — one bin was  $DY = 0 \pm 41$  from  $\pm 79k$  weights cancelling · (B)  $N_{\text{eff}}$  per bin: V+jets  $\approx 10$ , every other process  $10^3$ – $10^4$  · (C) DY per-event weights, uniformly  $\pm 10^5$

## The method — an algebraic identity

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Write the signed generator density as a difference of two positive densities:

$$\text{PDF}(\vec{x}) = a \text{PDF}_+ - b \text{PDF}_-, \quad a - b = 1$$

With  $P_+(\vec{x}) = a\text{PDF}_+ / (a\text{PDF}_+ + b\text{PDF}_-)$ :

$$\text{PDF}(\vec{x}) = \underbrace{(2P_+(\vec{x}) - 1)}_{g(\vec{x})} \cdot (a\text{PDF}_+ + b\text{PDF}_-)$$

The right factor is the **unsigned** density — what  $\sum |w|$  samples.

So  $\sum |w| g$  and  $\sum w$  estimate **the same distribution**. Yield-preserving by construction, not an approximation.

Exact for the *true*  $P_+$ . We use  $\hat{P}_+$  from a finite classifier — so closure becomes an **empirical** property that must be measured.

## Training region — train loose, infer tight

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$g(\vec{x})$  is a **generator property**; it does not know about the analysis selection.  
So we train on a far larger sample than the SR.

|              | region                                         |
|--------------|------------------------------------------------|
| <b>train</b> | all base cuts + veto of the $e\mu$ SR topology |
| <b>infer</b> | the tight $e\mu$ signal region                 |

**Disjoint by construction.** An event that is not "exactly one  $e\mu$  pair" can never be an SR event — no event-id bookkeeping needed.

Rejected alternatives: inverting MET (kinematically softer  $\rightarrow$  extrapolation) and inverting the c-jet requirement (flips into the *opposite* gen corner).

## Inputs — 20 generator-level features

| group           | variables                                                                                                                                   |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| LHE event       | <code>lhe_njets</code> , <code>lhe_nb</code> , <code>lhe_nc</code> , <code>lhe_nuds</code> , <code>lhe_nglu</code> , <code>lhe_npnlo</code> |
| LHE kinematics  | <code>lhe_ht</code> , <code>lhe_htincoming</code> , <code>lhe_vpt</code> , <code>lhe_alphas</code>                                          |
| gen partons     | multiplicity, <code>n_pt20/100/200</code> , incoming PDG IDs                                                                                |
| leading partons | <code>genparton1/2_pt</code> , <code>genparton1/2_eta</code>                                                                                |

**All generator-level.** The paper explicitly **rejects reco-level variables** — closure is only guaranteed on quantities the generator itself sampled.

The two weight classes separate visibly in nearly every one of these features.

# The classifier

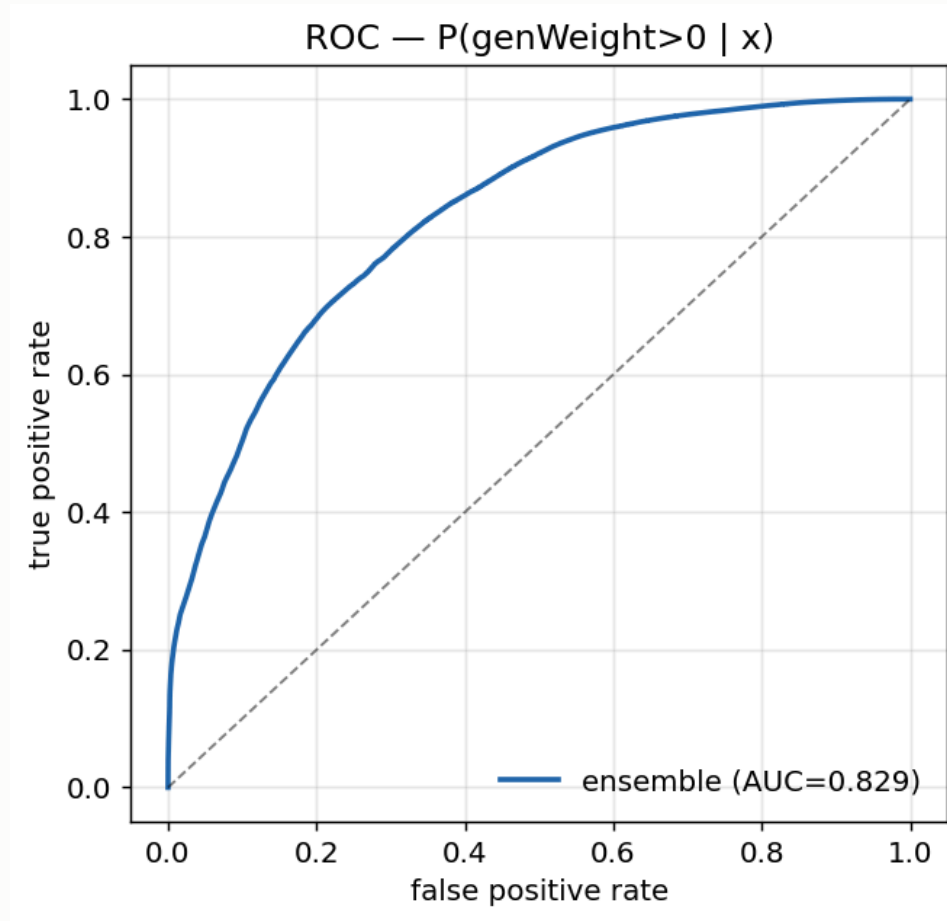
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| setting             | value                                                                |
|---------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| model               | HistGradientBoostingClassifier (scikit-learn)                        |
| inputs              | 20 generator-level ( <code>lhe_*</code> , <code>genparton_*</code> ) |
| training events     | 9.8M                                                                 |
| <b>ensemble AUC</b> | <b>0.829</b>                                                         |

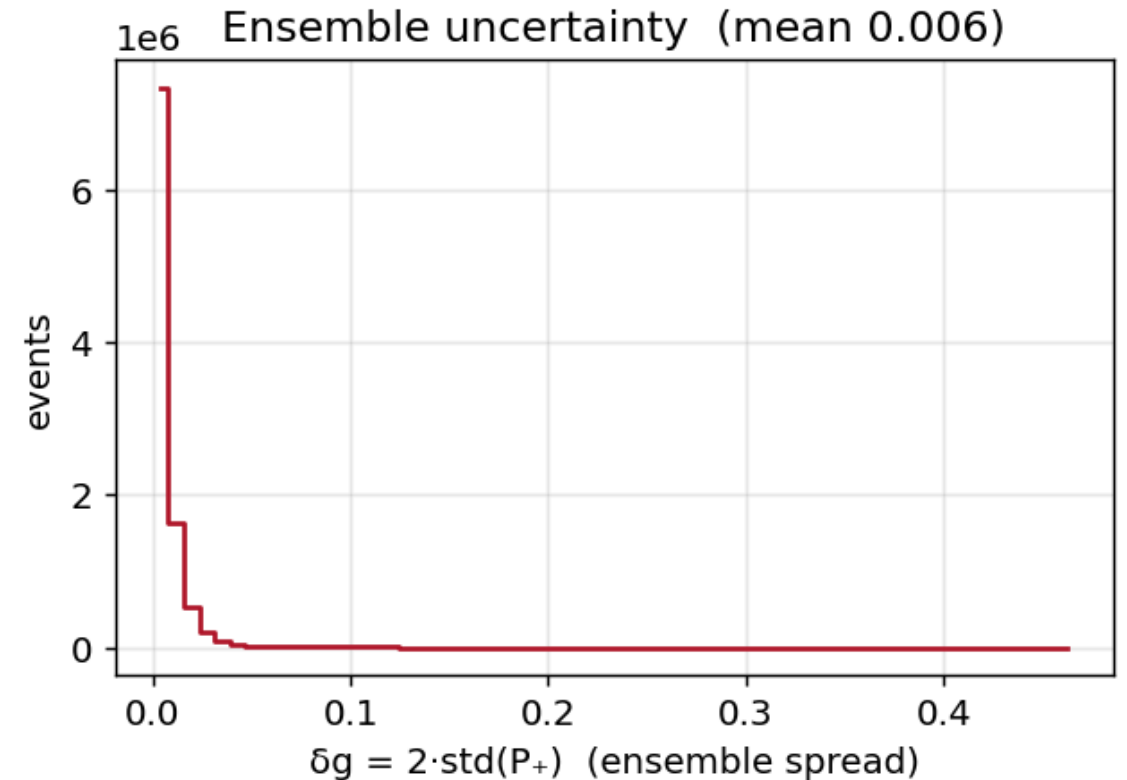
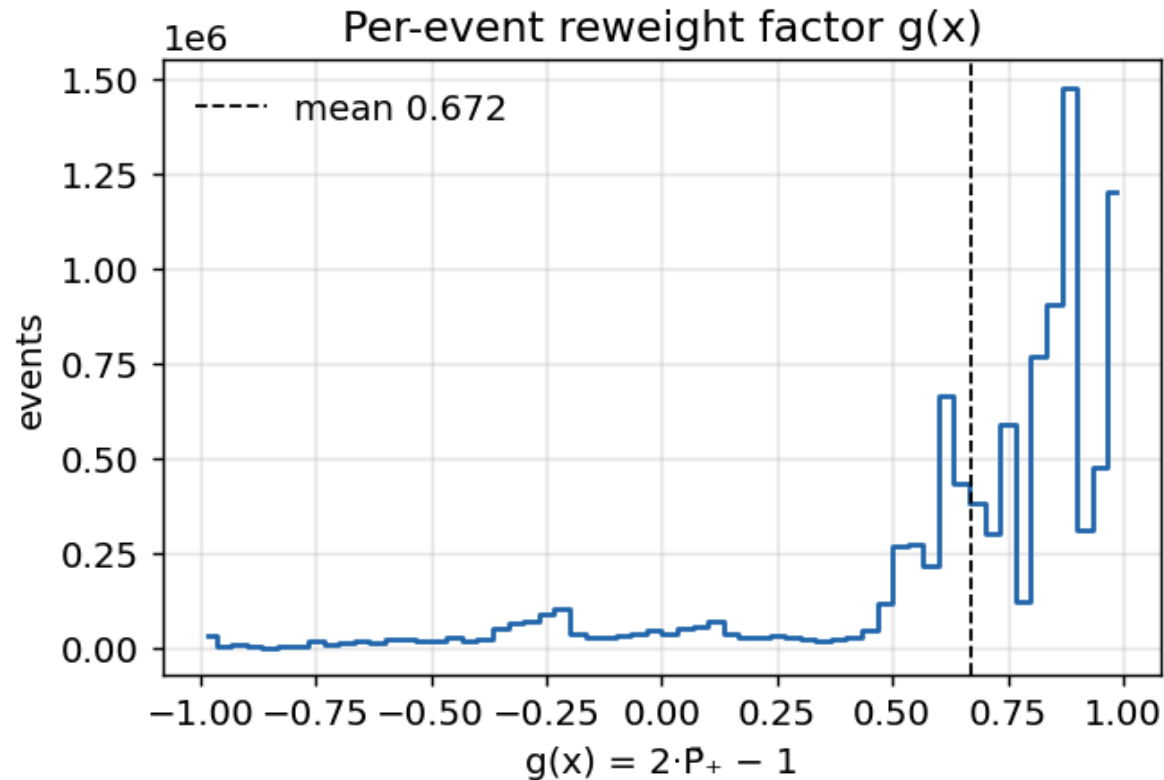
AUC 0.83 on an **intrinsically stochastic** target — the weight sign is not a deterministic function of the kinematics, so a perfect classifier cannot exist even in principle. 0.83 means the generator-level features genuinely carry the information the NLO subtraction encodes.



# Classifier ROC

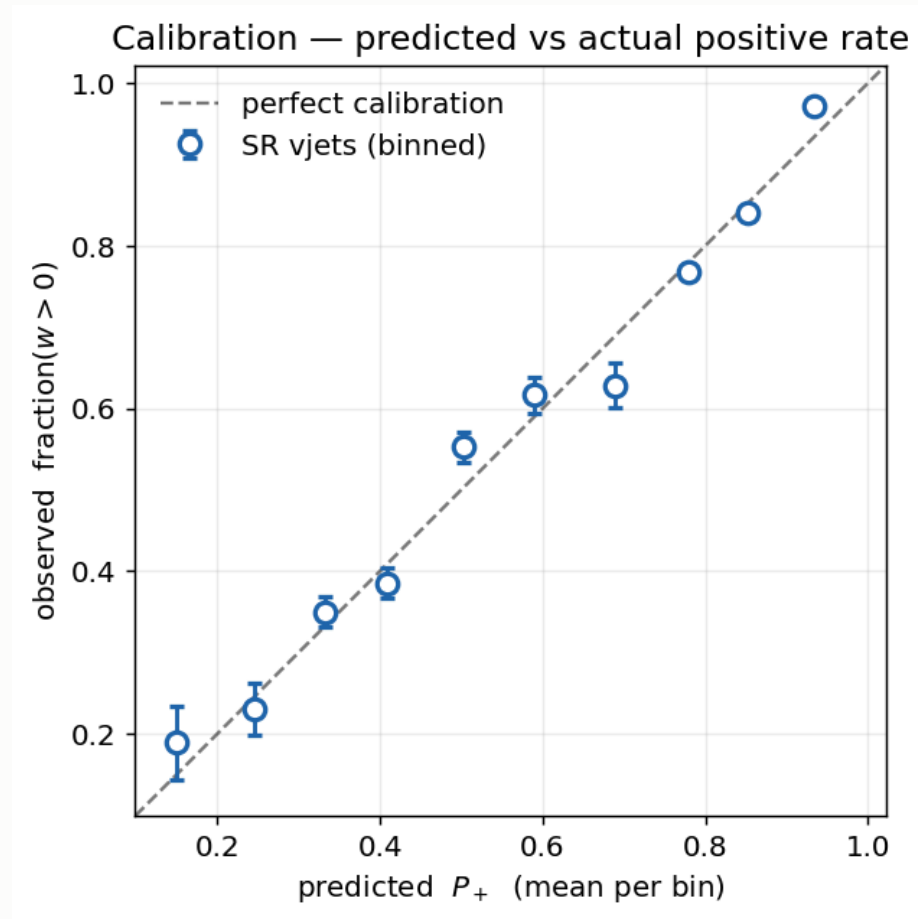


# The reweight factor and its spread



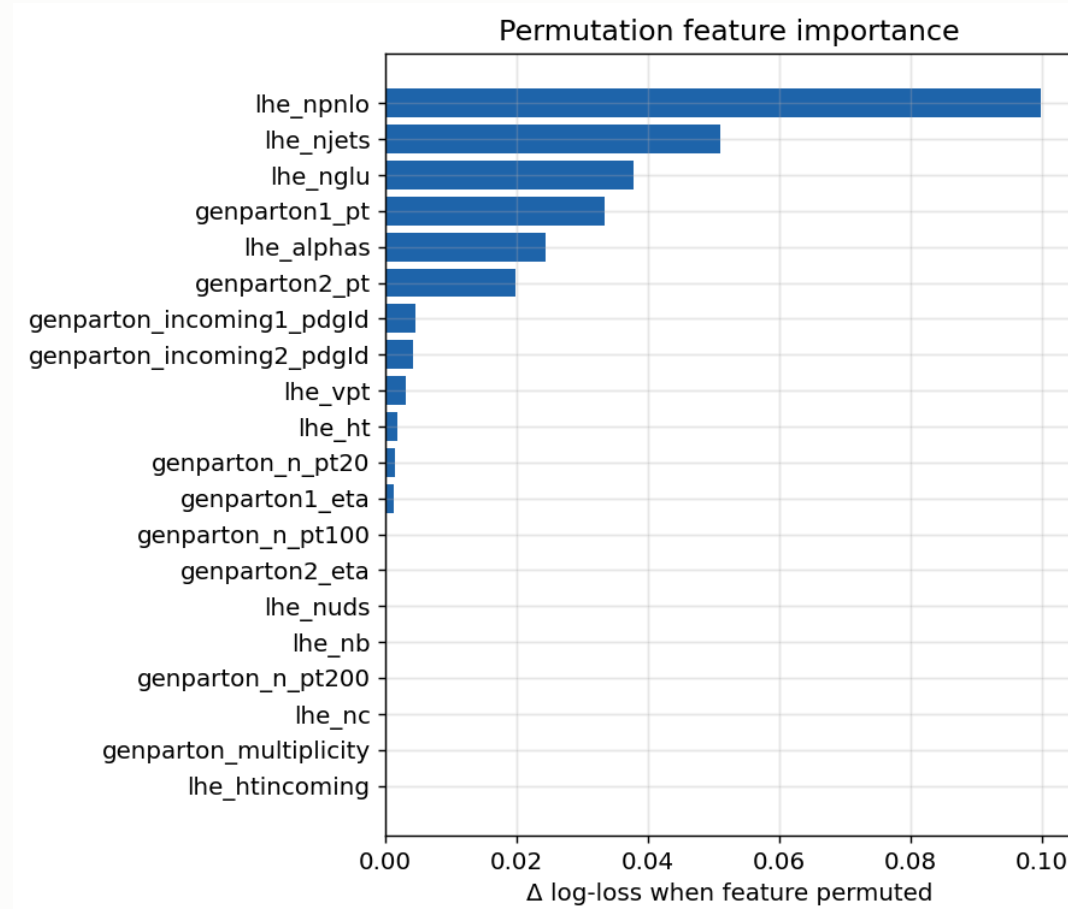
| quantity              | value                | reading                                                        |
|-----------------------|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| $g$ mean              | <b>0.672</b>         | $= 2 \times 0.836 - 1$ , matching the global positive fraction |
| $g$ range             | $[-0.991, 0.993]$    | inside the physical $[-1, 1]$ — no pathological events         |
| $\delta g$ mean / max | <b>0.006</b> / 0.467 | 20-model ensemble agreement is tight                           |

# Is $P_+$ calibrated outside the training region?



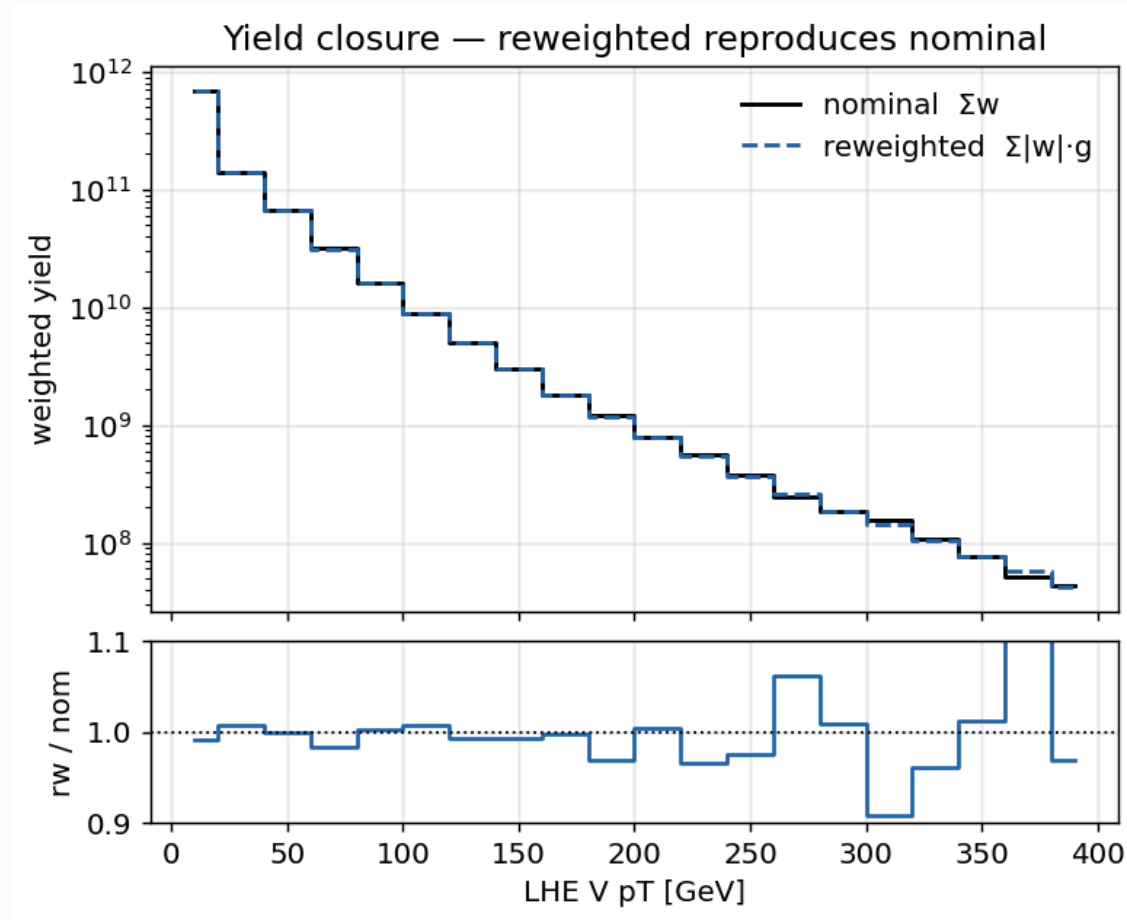
Bin SR events by **predicted**  $P_+$ , plot the **observed** fraction with  $w > 0$ . Points land on the diagonal across the full range ( $P_+ \approx 0.15 \rightarrow 0.93$ ) — the classifier is calibrated where it is applied, not only where it was trained.

# Which features carry the information



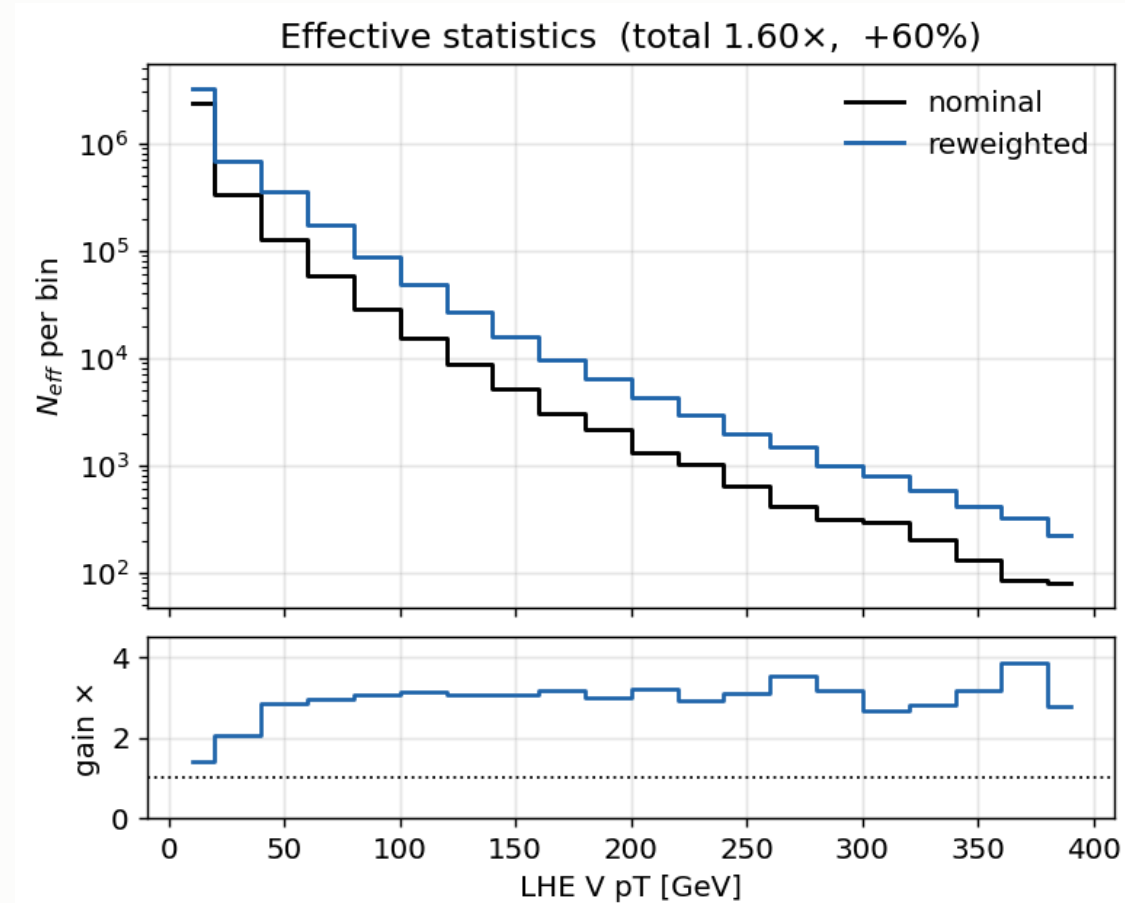
Permutation importance: the increase in log-loss when a feature is scrambled.

# Closure



Training-region closure **0.994** on 9.8M events — the reweighting removes variance and nothing else.

# The gain



Integrated gain **1.6×**; per-bin ratio  $\approx$ **3×** in the signal-rich bins.

# SR closure and the renormalisation

The SR is a small, kinematically-biased corner of the training domain, so the per-event  $g$  does not average to the *local* positive fraction:

| dataset         | rows   | $\sum  w g / \sum w$ |
|-----------------|--------|----------------------|
| DYto2L_2Jets_50 | 9,646  | 1.014                |
| WtoLNU_2Jets    | 485    | 1.133                |
| <b>total</b>    | 10,205 | <b>1.058</b>         |

**The reweighted template is renormalised to the nominal yield, per dataset** (DY  $\times 0.986$ , WtoLNU  $\times 0.900$ ). The yield is therefore **restored exactly**, while the variance reduction — which comes from per-bin spread, not the integral — is untouched.

This renormalisation is **our extension, not the paper's**. CMS\_negrw\_vjets covers the residual *method* uncertainty (the ensemble spread), which profiles to **0.0%**.

## 5 · W+jets jet-binned samples

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## Inclusive → jet-binned

AN-23-102 §2.3 rejects the inclusive NLO sample outright:

*"not used... 5 times smaller than LO and with large fraction of negative weights."*

| sample               | xsec (pb)     | events        | files        | neg-w        |
|----------------------|---------------|---------------|--------------|--------------|
| WtoLNu-2Jets_0J      | 55,760        | 678M          | 3,432        | 10.2%        |
| WtoLNu-2Jets_1J      | 9,529         | 523M          | 2,669        | 25.7%        |
| WtoLNu-2Jets_2J      | 3,532         | 345M          | 2,135        | 34.7%        |
| <b>sum</b>           | <b>68,821</b> | <b>1,546M</b> | <b>8,236</b> |              |
| <i>old inclusive</i> | <i>67,710</i> | <i>282M</i>   | <i>381</i>   | <i>16.1%</i> |

Cross sections from **XSDB**; sum within **+1.6%** of the inclusive — normal NLO merging spread, not a double-count. Measured negative-weight fractions match XSDB to ~1%.

XSDB labels these accuracy: "L0" — **wrong**, auto-populated. `amcatnloFXFX` is NLO, proven by the 10–35% negative weights, impossible at LO.

# Why the gain is not simply 5.5×

Raw events rise **5.5×**, but the useful quantity is effective statistics:

| sample           | $n_{eff}/N$  | equivalent lumi       |
|------------------|--------------|-----------------------|
| 0J               | 0.635        | 7.7 /fb               |
| 1J               | 0.237        | 13.0 /fb              |
| 2J               | 0.094        | 9.1 /fb               |
| <b>combined</b>  |              | <b>29.8 /fb</b>       |
| <i>inclusive</i> | <i>0.460</i> | <b><i>1.9 /fb</i></b> |

The inclusive sample spends most of its cross section on **0-jet** events, which almost never survive the  $\geq 1$  c-jet requirement.

Of the 4,851 surviving SR events, **2J alone contributes 69%** — despite being the smallest sample. The jet-binned samples are enriched in exactly what the selection needs.

## W+jets result: 1160 → 1034

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|                       | before | after        |
|-----------------------|--------|--------------|
| <b>expected UL</b>    | 1160   | <b>1034</b>  |
| V+jets $n_{eff}$ (SR) | 280    | <b>1170</b>  |
| V+jets stat. error    | 5.98%  | <b>2.92%</b> |
| V+jets rate           | 1508   | 1523         |

**The rate barely moved while the statistical error halved** — the signature of a statistics gain, not a normalisation change.

## 6 · The combine card

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# Card structure

```
imax 6      # 6 channels: SR_hplusc + 5 argmax CRs
jmax 5      # 6 processes minus one
kmax *      # nuisances counted automatically

shapes * SR_hplusc v11_hplusc_2dcat.root \
        SR_hplusc_$PROCESS SR_hplusc_$PROCESS_$SYSTEMATIC
... one line per channel
```

|             |                                                            |
|-------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| channels    | SR_hplusc, CR_higgsbkg, CR_tt, CR_st, CR_diboson, CR_vjets |
| processes   | hplusc, higgsbkg, tt, st, diboson, vjets                   |
| binning     | <b>10 bins per channel</b> — the winning MVA score         |
| histograms  | 1,626 in the ROOT file (nominal + all up/down)             |
| observation | -1 in every channel — <b>Asimov, blind</b>                 |

# The two special entries

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## A free-floating tt normalisation:

```
rate_tt  rateParam  *  tt  1.0  [0,5]
```

One parameter, **shared across all six channels**, so CR\_tt (94% pure, 44k events) determines the tt normalisation in the SR. This is why t $\bar$ t carries no `xsec` lnN — its rate comes from data, following AN-23-102.

## Bin-by-bin MC statistics:

```
SR_hplusc    autoMCStats 10  
CR_higgsbkg  autoMCStats 10  
... one line per channel
```

Barlow–Beeston-lite. Threshold 10 means bins with  $n_{eff} > 10$  get a single Gaussian nuisance; sparser bins get individual Poisson terms.

## How a template becomes a card entry

```
parquet → read_scale = lumi × xsec / sumw → TH1 per (channel, process)  
→ + one TH1 per systematic ↑↓
```

**Normalisation is a two-place mechanism.** The per-event `genWeight` enters post-selection through the weights container; the denominator `sumw` is summed **pre-selection** and written to `sumw_records` — including chunks that select zero events. Reading it from parquet metadata instead undercounts.

Object shifts (JES/JER, lepton scale/res) cannot be weights — they change the MVA score, so each is a **separate parquet tree**, re-selected and re-scored, giving 12 shifted directories.

## 6 · Systematics

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# The full inventory

22 shape · 9 lnN · `rate_tt` free rateParam · autoMCStats (threshold 10)

| shape (weight)                                                        | shape (object shift)                                                               |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>pileup</code>                                                   | <code>CMS_scale_j_2022</code> (JES)                                                |
| <code>ps_isr</code> , <code>ps_fsr</code>                             | <code>CMS_res_j_2022</code> (JER)                                                  |
| <code>scalevar_muR</code> , <code>_muF</code> , <code>_muR_muF</code> | <code>CMS_scale_e_2022</code> , <code>CMS_res_e_2022</code>                        |
| <code>lhe_pdf</code> , <code>lhe_alphaS</code>                        | <code>CMS_scale_m_2022</code> , <code>CMS_res_m_2022</code>                        |
| <code>muon_id</code> , <code>muon_iso</code>                          |                                                                                    |
| <code>electron_id</code> , <code>electron_reco</code> ×3              | lnN                                                                                |
| <code>CMS_ctag2d_2022</code>                                          | <code>lumi_13p6TeV</code> , <code>xsec_st/diboson/vjets/higgsbkg</code>            |
| <code>CMS_negrw_vjets</code>                                          | <code>BR_HtoWW</code> , <code>BR_Htautau</code> , <code>xsec_hplusc_4FS_5FS</code> |
| <code>flavor_composition_ggH</code> (placeholder)                     |                                                                                    |

## Object shifts need full reprocessing

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JES/JER and lepton scale/resolution **change the MVA score**, so they cannot be applied as an event weight.

Each is a **separate parquet tree**, re-run through the full selection *and* re-scored by the network — 12 shifted directories.

Inference coverage over every shift directory is **verified after each rebuild** — a partially-scored set would leave object-shift templates frozen at nominal.

# Top- $p_T$ reweighting

Implemented following `hh2bbww` (the framework behind AN-24-091), using the **theory-based (NNLO/NLO)** parameterisation with the Run 3 rescaling:

| property     | value                               |
|--------------|-------------------------------------|
| form         | theory-based NNLO/NLO               |
| Run 3 factor | $\times (0.991 + 7.5e-5 \cdot p_T)$ |
| nominal      | reweighted                          |
| $p_T$ cap    | none — well-behaved at high $p_T$   |

```
sf_run2 = 0.103*exp(-0.0118*pT) - 0.000134*pT + 0.973
sf       = (0.991 + 0.000075*pT) * sf_run2
weight   = sqrt(prod(sf))           # over the two gen tops
down     = 1.0                     # "no correction" is the variation
```

The variation is **down = 1.0** ("no correction"), symmetric about the nominal.

# Higgs heavy-flavour

ggH is only **13.1%** of the merged `higgsbkg` group (VBF 29.0%, ggZH 23.3%, ZH 21.0%, WH 9.1%), so a flat  $\ln N$  on the group either over-penalises the other 87% or must be diluted to an average — and cannot produce a shape effect.

**Implemented as a per-event weight instead**, keyed on gen-jet flavour.

**Why our Bkg-Higgs impact stays small even once activated.** Freezing it moves the limit by  $<1$  unit, against **7.6%** in AN-23-102. Two causes: the per-event weight is **not yet active**, and `higgsbkg` is only **0.6% of our SR** — ours is tt-dominated, theirs is Higgs-background-dominated. It will rise, but **not to 7.6%**.

**Replaced with a per-event weight**, ported from HiggsDNA `Higgs_plus_HF_syst`:

```
num_HF_jets = ak.sum(genJets.hadronFlavour == 4, axis=-1) # pT>25, |eta|<2.5
up = where(num_HF_jets > 0, 1.5, 1.0) # AN-23-102: 50% on ggH
down = where(num_HF_jets > 0, 0.5, 1.0)
```

Keys on **gen-jet flavour**, so process grouping stops mattering — and it produces

## MET unclustered energy

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**Implemented, not yet in the card** — it needs the shifted trees from a reprocessing pass, so it does not appear in the 22 shape nuisances above.

For Run 3 PuppiMET the shift is taken directly from the NanoAOD branches:

```
events.PuppiMET.ptUnclusteredUp / ptUnclusteredDown  
events.PuppiMET.phiUnclusteredUp / phiUnclusteredDown
```

Matches HiggsDNA `MET_syst_Unclustered` — same branches, same up/down ordering.

# What is implemented

| systematic          | implementation                                     |
|---------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| CMS_negrw_vjets     | ensemble spread of the negative-weight reweighting |
| CMS_ctag2d_2022     | 2D CvL/CvB SF, applied natively in the processor   |
| electron_reco ×3    | p <sub>T</sub> -binned (<20, 20–75, >75 GeV)       |
| lhe_pdf, lhe_alphaS | NNPDF replicas, MC2Hessian                         |
| top_pt              | hh2bbww theory form — <i>pending activation</i>    |
| higgs_plus_c        | per-event HF weight — <i>pending activation</i>    |
| MET unclustered     | object shift — <i>pending activation</i>           |

The last three are implemented and verified but **not in the current card** — each needs its weight column or shifted tree from a reprocessing pass.

## Deliberately excluded

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| item                                      | decision                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|-------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>muon reco SF</b>                       | <b>not applicable</b> — HiggsDNA exposes no reco key; hh2bbww registers <code>mu_id_sf</code> / <code>mu_iso_sf</code> and no <code>mu_reco_sf</code> . Two frameworks, same conclusion. |
| <b>PU jet ID</b>                          | absent from both frameworks for Run 3                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>UE / tune</b>                          | requires <b>dedicated tune samples</b> — cannot be a weight                                                                                                                              |
| <code>hdamp</code> ,<br><code>mtop</code> | sample-based tt modelling — <b>under consideration</b> , see next slide                                                                                                                  |

## tt modelling: **hdamp** and **mtop**

Two standard Run 3  $t\bar{t}$  modelling uncertainties, both **not currently in the card**:

| term         | what it is                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|--------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>hdamp</b> | The Powheg damping parameter controlling the matching between the NLO matrix element and the parton shower. It sets how much hard radiation comes from the ME rather than the shower, so varying it changes the <b>jet multiplicity and jet <math>p_T</math> spectrum</b> of $t\bar{t}$ . |
| <b>mtop</b>  | The top-quark mass used in generation. Varying it (typically $\pm 1$ GeV) shifts the $t\bar{t}$ <b>kinematics and acceptance</b> .                                                                                                                                                        |

Neither can be applied as an event weight — both require **dedicated alternative samples** generated with the varied parameter.

**Undecided whether to add these.** They are standard in Run 3  $t\bar{t}$  analyses, but absent from AN-23-102 Table 16, and  $t\bar{t}$  normalisation here is already taken from data via the free `rate_tt`. Adding them means generating and processing new samples.



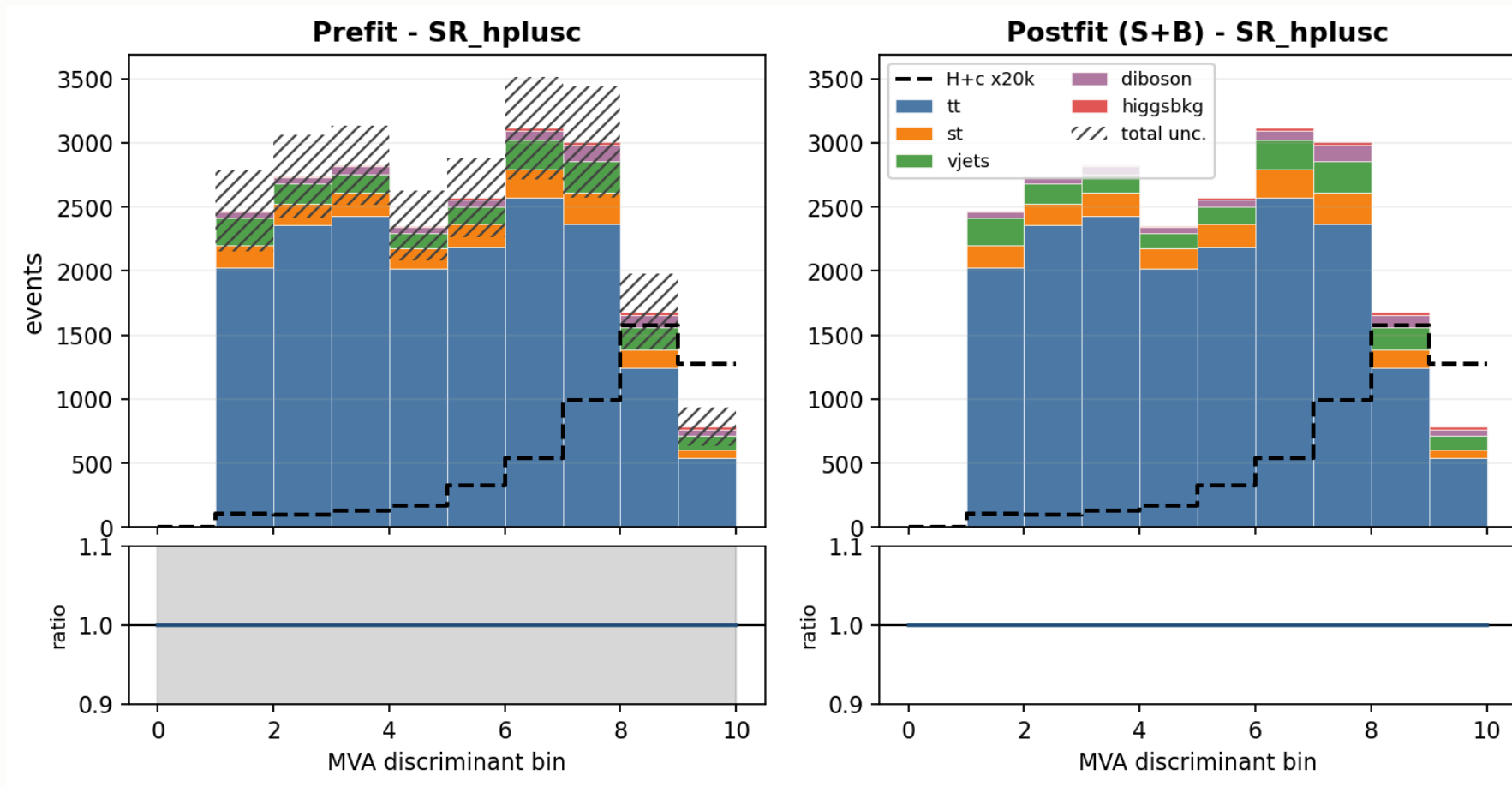
# What moves the limit

Each nuisance frozen in turn;  **$\Delta$  is the improvement in the expected limit.**

| frozen                                   | limit      | $\Delta$   | % of 1034    |
|------------------------------------------|------------|------------|--------------|
| <b>all constrained</b> (stat-only)       | <b>641</b> | <b>393</b> | <b>38.0%</b> |
| theory shapes (scale + PS + $\alpha_S$ ) | 883        | 151        | 14.6%        |
| xsec_hplusc_4FS_5FS                      | 921        | 113        | 10.9%        |
| scalevar_muF                             | 944        | 90         | 8.7%         |
| autoMCStats (all)                        | 956        | 78         | 7.5%         |
| CMS_ctag2d_2022                          | 964        | 70         | 6.8%         |
| rate_tt                                  | 1011       | 23         | 2.2%         |
| JES                                      | 1023       | 11         | 1.1%         |

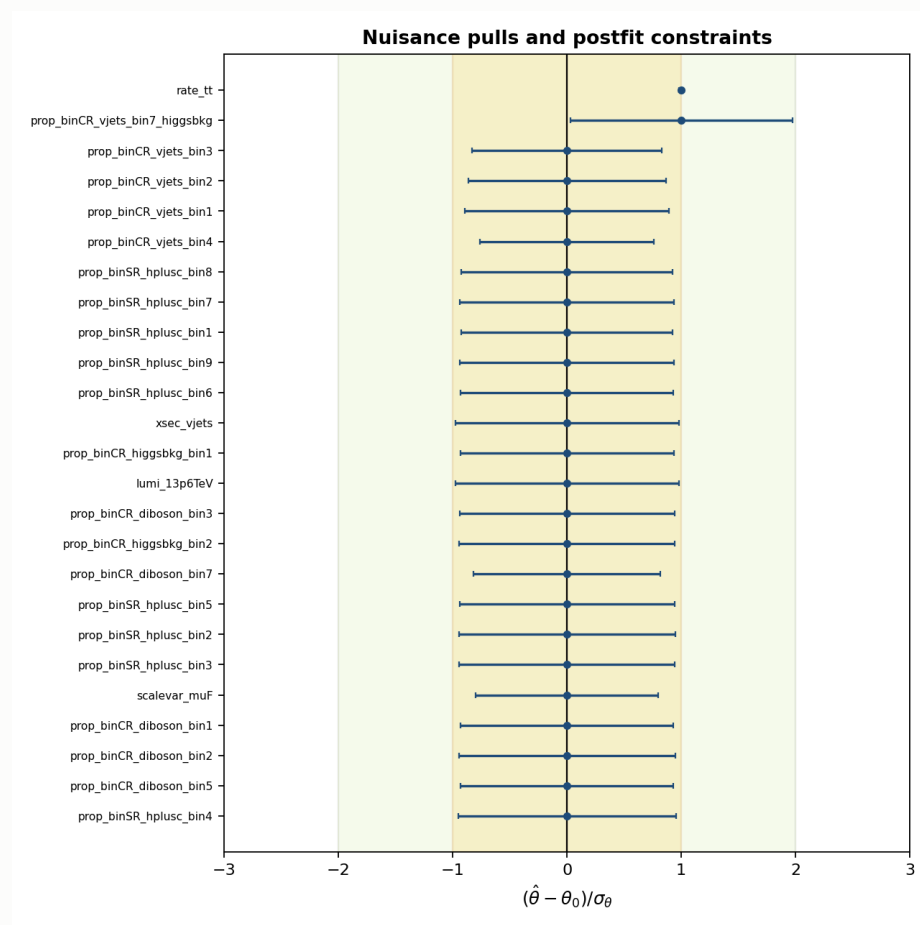
**autoMCStats is no longer the leading term.** It was dominant before the W+jets change; at 7.5% the analysis is no longer MC-stat-limited in the way it was. Signal theory now leads.

# Template composition — signal region



Backgrounds stacked, H+c overlaid ( $\times 20k$ ). Hatched band = **prefit** total uncertainty,  $\approx 14\%$  per bin. Postfit errors are absent because combine writes a **zero postfit covariance** on an Asimov fit.

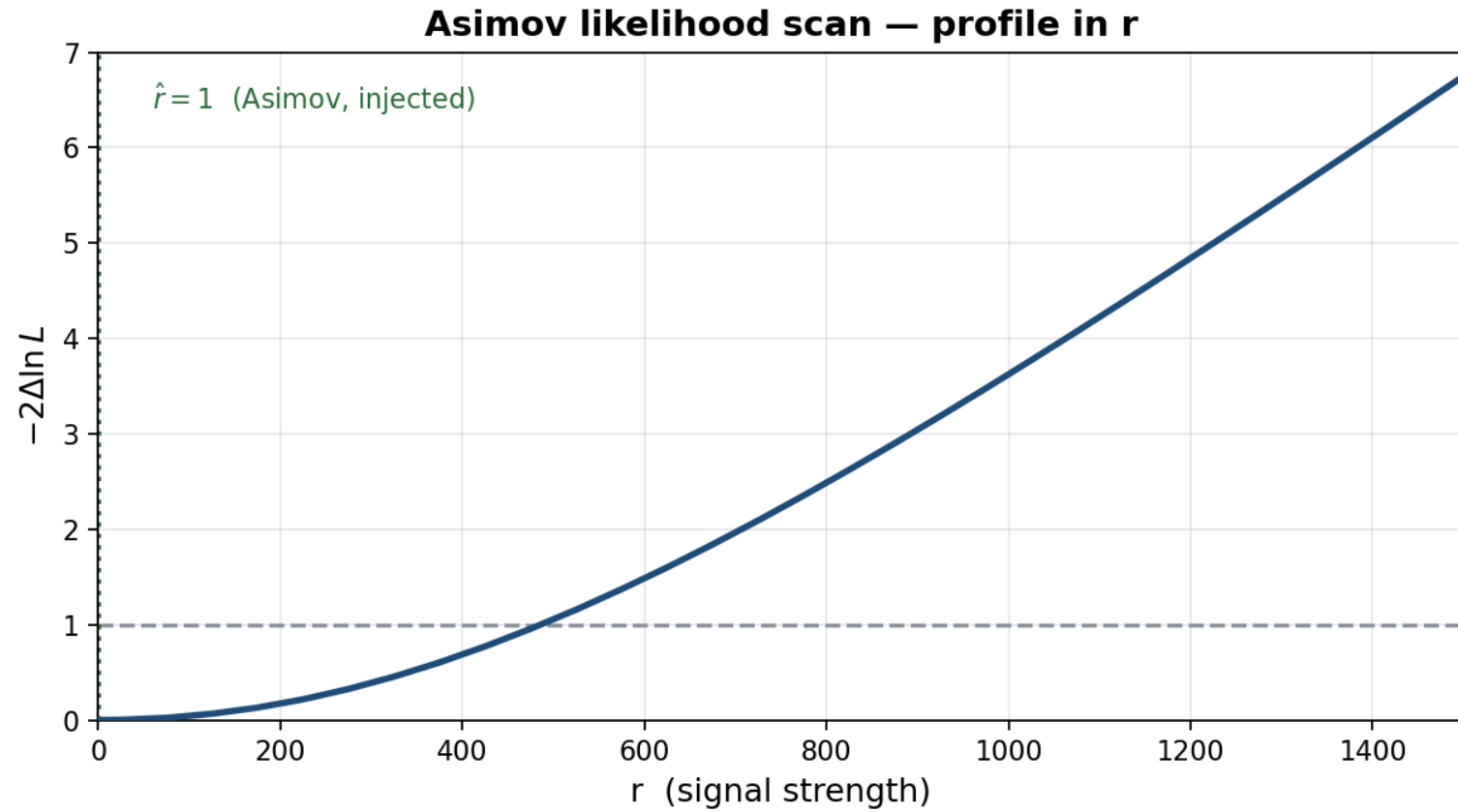
# Nuisance pulls and constraints



All Gaussian nuisances sit at **zero pull with ~unit width** — correct for an Asimov fit, and the check that nothing is being pulled or over-constrained.

Two entries are not Gaussian and should not be read as pulls:

# Likelihood scan



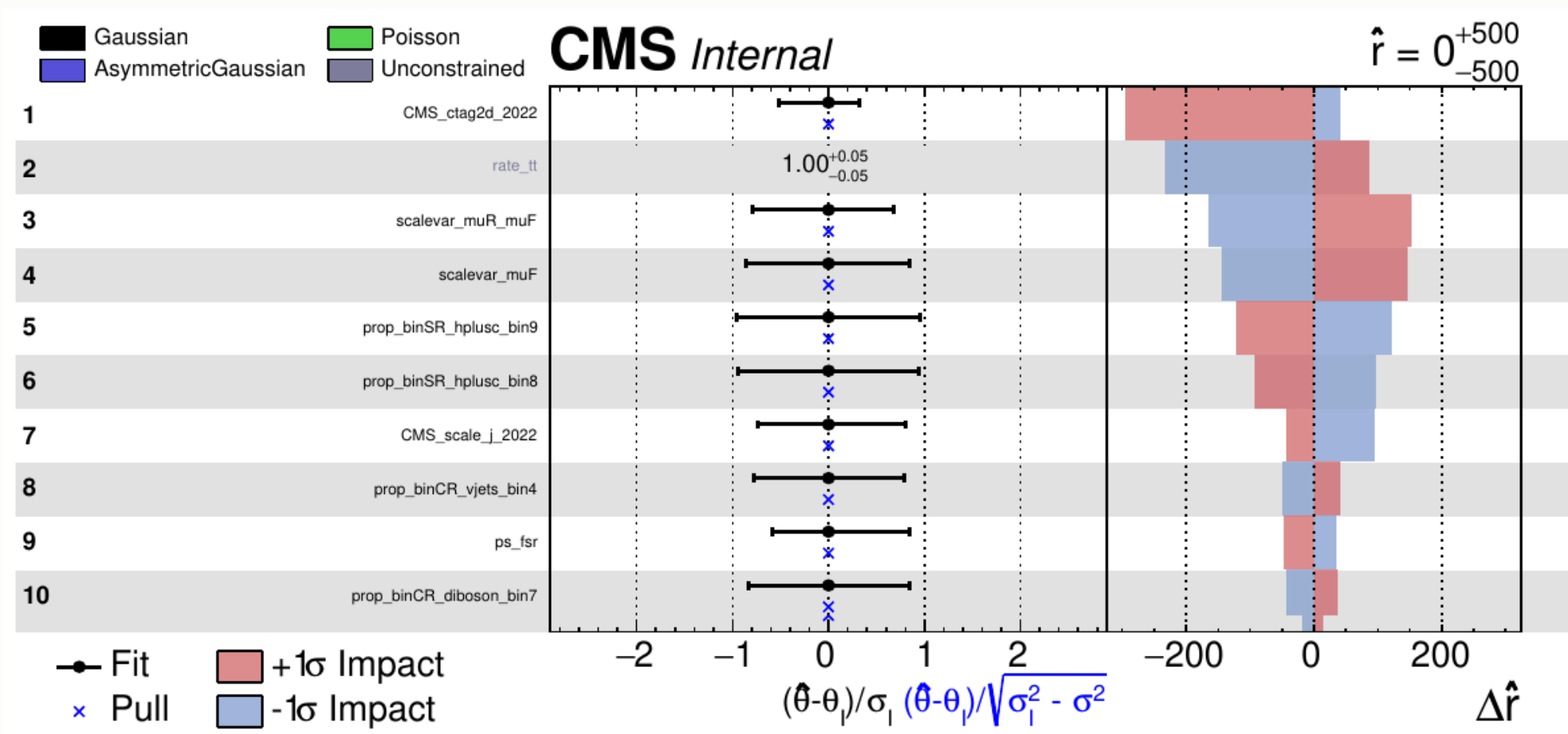
# What the likelihood scan shows

The profile likelihood in the signal strength — all nuisances minimised at each point in  $r$ .

| feature                 | value            | meaning                                               |
|-------------------------|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| minimum                 | $\hat{r} = 1$    | the fit recovers the injected Asimov signal — no bias |
| $-2\Delta \ln L = 1$    | $r \approx 525$  | the $1\sigma$ interval on $r$                         |
| $-2\Delta \ln L = 3.84$ | $r \approx 1075$ | the $2\sigma$ crossing                                |
| curvature               | —                | how fast the likelihood falls away = the sensitivity  |

The 3.84 crossing (**1075**) sits close to the quoted CLs limit (**1034**) — the two constructions agree when the background-only and signal+background hypotheses are well separated, which is the regime here.

# Nuisance impacts — top 10



The header  $\hat{r} = 0^{+500}_{-500}$  is a **plotImpacts rounding artefact** — the actual fit returns  $\hat{r} = 0.99996, -513/+483$ , i.e. exactly the injected Asimov value.

# Reading the impacts — the asymmetries

**Left panel** — the pull  $(\hat{\theta} - \theta_0)/\sigma_\theta$ . All pulls sit at zero:

this is an **Asimov** fit, so by construction nothing is pulled. A non-zero pull here would mean the fit is being dragged, and would need explaining.

**Right panel** —  $\Delta\hat{r}$  when each nuisance is moved by  $\pm 1\sigma$ .

**Red (+1 $\sigma$ ) and blue (−1 $\sigma$ ) are not mirror images.** Three sources of asymmetry:

| source                | why                                                                                                    |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>asymmetric lnN</b> | <code>xsec_st</code> is <code>0.9873/1.0167</code> — the up and down variations differ by construction |
| <b>template shape</b> | up/down shifts of JES or ctag move events between bins non-linearly                                    |
| <b>re-profiling</b>   | pushing one nuisance lets the others re-fit, and they respond differently in each direction            |

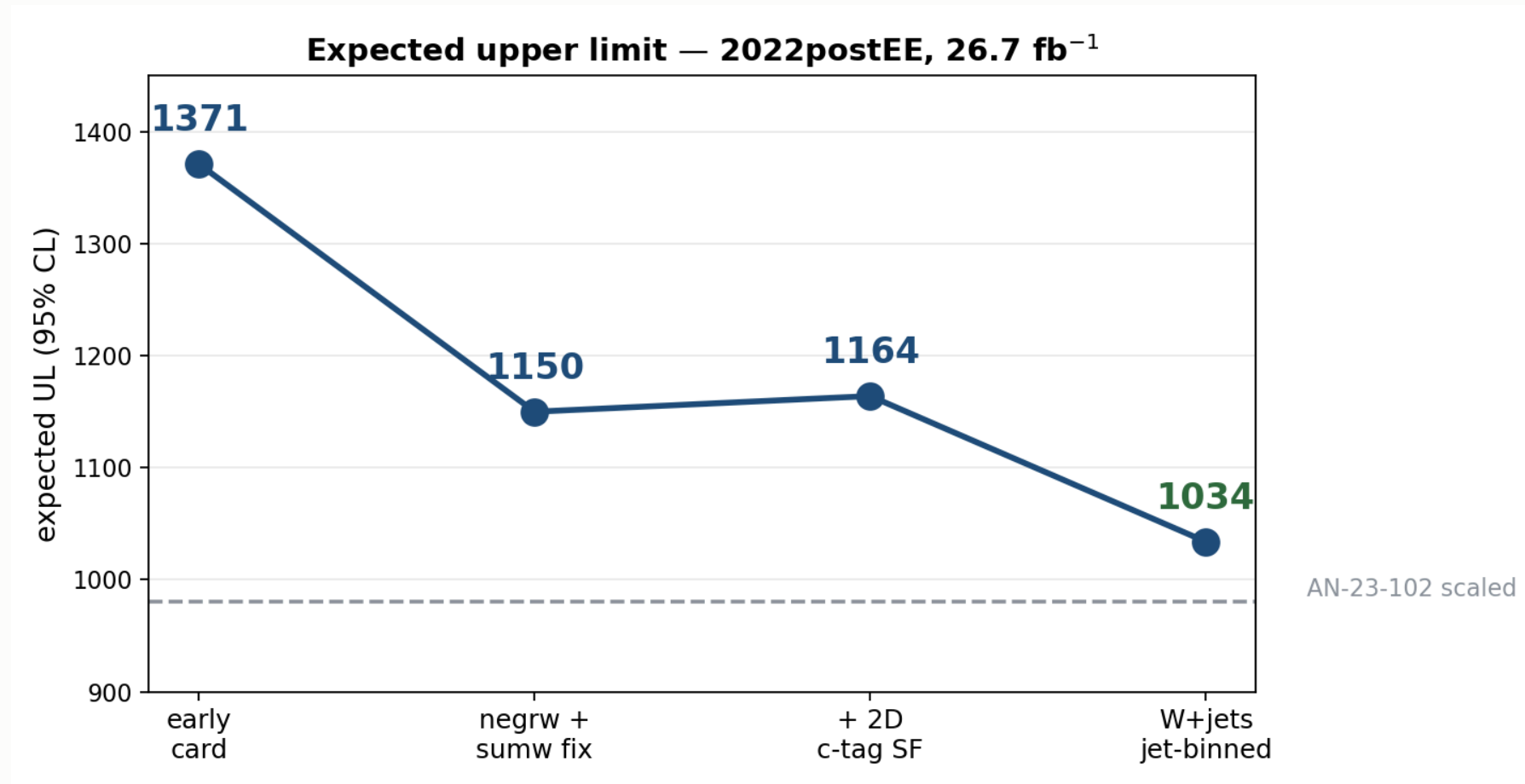
The **fit range matters**. An earlier run with `--rMin 0` clipped every  $-1\sigma$  impact at the boundary and produced a one-sided plot. A symmetric range around  $\hat{r}$  is required for the impacts to be meaningful.

## 7 · Status and outlook

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# The road so far



Note the suppressed zero on the y-axis — the c-tag step is a genuine but small **+14** increase, not the spike it appears to be.

# Where we stand

|                                           | limit       |
|-------------------------------------------|-------------|
| AN-23-102 scaled to 26.7 fb <sup>-1</sup> | <b>1144</b> |
| <b>this analysis</b>                      | <b>1034</b> |
| our statistical only                      | <b>641</b>  |

**Better than** the published analysis scaled to our luminosity — 1034 vs 1144, a **9.6% improvement**, on **5× less data**.

**The scaling is indicative, not rigorous.**  $503 \times \sqrt{138/26.7} = 1144$  assumes a purely statistics-limited extrapolation. AN-23-102's Table 17 puts its statistical term at 73.8%, so it is *not* fully statistics-limited — the true scaled value would be somewhat **worse** than 1144, making our margin **larger** than 9.6%, not smaller.

The systematic breakdown of the 1034 is **under investigation** — the full term-by-term comparison against AN-23-102 Table 17 is not yet settled.

# What is still missing

**No data/MC agreement plots yet** — the analysis is blind and the comparison plots are still being produced.

| item                                                     | status                                               |
|----------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>4FS/5FS signal theory</b>                             | placeholder 1.30 — needs re-derivation at 13.6 TeV   |
| <b>Trigger scale factors</b>                             | implemented, <b>not yet enabled</b>                  |
| <b>Higgs heavy-flavour</b> ( <code>higgs_plus_c</code> ) | implemented, pending activation                      |
| <b>top-<math>p_T</math> reweighting</b>                  | implemented, pending activation                      |
| Dataset substitutions                                    | W+jets $p_T$ -binned (full AN stitch)                |
|                                                          | DY $\rightarrow$ Z $\rightarrow$ $\tau\tau$ filtered |
|                                                          | tt / single-top <code>-ext</code> samples            |
|                                                          | <code>WZto3LNu</code>                                |

# Priorities

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| # | item                                                     | why                                         |
|---|----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Re-derive <code>xsec_hplusc_4FS_5FS</code>               | 30% flat lnN on a statistics-starved signal |
| 2 | Enable trigger SFs                                       | implemented, one flag                       |
| 3 | Activate <code>higgs_plus_c</code> + <code>top_pt</code> | proper HF and tt treatment                  |
| 4 | Add the missing datasets                                 | more MC statistics                          |
| 5 | Decorrelate <code>CMS_ctag2d_2022</code>                 | currently one nuisance over the whole plane |

# Summary

**Expected UL 1371 → 1034 · statistical-only 641**

**V+jets  $n_{eff}$  280 → 1170**

**Within ~5% of the Run 2 analysis scaled to our luminosity**

Remaining: 4FS/5FS re-derivation, trigger SFs, dataset substitutions